

# Adam Hickey

INDEPENDENT PRODUCT DESIGNER • STRATEGY • UX • SYSTEMS • PROTOTYPING • BUILD

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

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Independent product designer with 20 years in complicated enterprise software, for organizations like Cargill, Intel, CBRE and Toro. I untangle complex products, define what is worth building, and turn it into something people can actually use: enterprise platforms, design systems, and working prototypes. I use AI to scale the design system rather than just my own output, and increasingly build the software myself when a prototype answers a question faster than a spec does. The judgment calls stay human.

## EXPERIENCE

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### Independent Practice — Product Design

2026 – Present

- Product definition, design, systems and prototyping for complicated software, from ambiguity through to something a team can react to.
- **Door County Found** — a regional travel guide where every place is structured data rather than a blog post. Defined, designed and built end to end, including the editing workflow.

### RBA Inc — Lead UX Product Designer

2013 – 2026

- Led enterprise product design and UX strategy for clients in manufacturing, healthcare, financial services, and the public sector.
- Worked with product, engineering, and business teams so design decisions showed up in the numbers they already track: efficiency, adoption, quality, and ROI.
- Built and governed design systems across SAP, Microsoft, Umbraco, and Sitecore platforms, and led accessibility, DesignOps and governance practices.
- Used AI to scale the design system: drafting documentation, auditing for drift, checking design against code, and pulling research together. Human judgment on every decision.

## SELECTED PROJECTS

- Scaling enterprise product design across 40+ SAP applications (design systems, governance, accessibility).
- Reducing operational overhead by 80% through a USDA grant-management portal (research, workflows, accessibility).
- Orchestrating real-time logistics for a 450+ truck fleet (cockpit UI, fleet visibility, dispatcher workflows).

## CORE CAPABILITIES

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Product Strategy • UX & Interaction Design • Design Systems • Rapid Prototyping • Front-End Build • AI-Assisted Design & Development • Research & Synthesis • Information Architecture • Accessibility

## DESIGN TOOLS & PLATFORMS

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Figma/FigJam • Adobe Creative Suite • Claude Code • ChatGPT • Gemini • HTML/CSS/JavaScript • Astro • Git/GitHub • SAP Fiori • Sitecore • Umbraco • SharePoint • Power BI • WCAG 2.1 AA

## EDUCATION

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**Bachelor of Science in Graphic Design**, University of Minnesota–Twin Cities (2005)

## PRIOR PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Pixel Farm — Interactive Designer / Developer

Jan 2008 – Apr 2013

- Designed and shipped two native iOS apps and an iPad application, including a centennial app for Dorsey & Whitney with an interactive timeline.
- Built the “Build Your Boat” configurator for Lund Boats and a custom store-locator integration for Fulton Beer.
- Designed and built front-end experiences in HTML, CSS, and jQuery across Joomla! and WordPress; created user flows and prototypes, and led rebrands and visual identity systems.

### LEVEL — Interactive Designer

Jan 2006 – Jan 2008

Designed and developed front-end websites in HTML, CSS, and Flash; partnered with project managers, creative leads, writers, and developers.

### ByDesign — Graphic Designer

Jan 2005 – Jan 2006

Supported University of Minnesota and Twin Cities clients with in-house creative; led a small design team producing interactive Flash games and digital assets.